

NAS (GRADE 9) MOCK TEST - SOCIAL STUDIES

Early Human Society: Nomadism to Early Civilisation

Application-level mock (40 MCQs) - modelled on the NAS 2024 Grade 9 pattern.

Competency: Analyses the effect of various changes in early human society - from nomadism to settled life and early civilisation (agriculture, food habits, technologies, habitation, work and socio-cultural beliefs such as Ahimsa, and the fallout of wars).

General Instructions

1. This mock has 40 multiple-choice questions (MCQs).
2. Four question types are used, 10 questions each.
3. Each question has four options - A, B, C and D. Only ONE is correct.
4. The Answer Key with explanations is given at the end.
5. There is no negative marking in NAS.

About the references (read before verifying):

The concrete provided source is the NAS 2024 Grade 9 model paper (Q3 p.3 metallurgy; Q18 p.10 Magadha; Q19 p.10 Indus Valley source). Other items cite NCERT 'Our Past-I' chapters. NOTE: the early-society TEXTBOOK pages were not provided, so exact page/line numbers are given only for the NAS model paper; the rest are chapter-level references.

SECTION 1 - WHICH OF THE FOLLOWING IS CORRECT

Apply the idea and choose the CORRECT statement.

1. Early civilisations in India advanced in metallurgy. Which statement about its impact is CORRECT?
 - A. It decreased agricultural productivity.
 - B. It increased trade and commerce.
 - C. It increased social equality.
 - D. It reduced cultural exchange.

Reference from: NAS 2024 Grade 9 model paper, Q3 (p.3); NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.4.

2. A region has the Ganga's vast plains and abundant natural resources (like Magadha). Which inference about its development is CORRECT?
 - A. An arid climate and lack of rivers made it nomadic.
 - B. Rugged terrain and minerals led only to a military culture.
 - C. Fertile plains and resources aided agriculture, trade and strong political centres.
 - D. Deep forests kept it isolated into small settlements.

Reference from: NAS 2024 Grade 9 model paper, Q18 (p.10); NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.6.

3. Which is the MOST useful primary source for studying the Indus Valley civilisation?
 - A. Inscriptions on temples
 - B. Manuscripts of religious texts
 - C. Archaeological remains
 - D. Colonial administrative records

Reference from: NAS 2024 Grade 9 model paper, Q19 (p.10); NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.1 & Ch.4.

4. A group of early people move from place to place, hunting animals and gathering fruits. Which statement is CORRECT?
- A. They are settled farmers.
 - B. They are nomadic hunter-gatherers.
 - C. They live in planned cities.
 - D. They use iron ploughs.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.2 'On the Trail of the Earliest People'.

5. Which statement about the beginning of agriculture is CORRECT?
- A. It made people wander more than before.
 - B. It led people to settle down and grow food.
 - C. It ended the use of all tools.
 - D. It stopped people from rearing animals.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.3 'From Gathering to Growing Food'.

6. Which statement about a Harappan city is CORRECT?
- A. It had no planning at all.
 - B. It had planned drainage and brick houses.
 - C. Its people knew no metal.
 - D. It had no trade with other regions.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.4 'In the Earliest Cities'.

7. Which statement about Ahimsa is CORRECT?
- A. It means the love of war.
 - B. It means non-violence.
 - C. It is a kind of farming tool.
 - D. It is a kind of metal.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.7 'New Questions and Ideas'.

8. After the Kalinga war, which statement about Ashoka is CORRECT?
- A. He happily fought many more wars.
 - B. He felt remorse, gave up war and followed dhamma / ahimsa.
 - C. He destroyed all the cities.
 - D. He gave up being a king.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.8 'Ashoka, the Emperor Who Gave Up War'.

9. Which statement about the order of tool materials over time is CORRECT?
- A. Iron -> copper -> stone
 - B. Stone -> copper/bronze -> iron
 - C. Copper -> stone -> iron
 - D. Iron -> stone -> copper

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.2-4.

10. Which statement about megaliths is CORRECT?

- A. They are modern houses.
- B. They are big-stone burials that tell us about beliefs about death.
- C. They are a kind of farming tool.
- D. They are a kind of pottery.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.5 'What Bones and Burials Tell Us'.

SECTION 2 - WHICH OF THE FOLLOWING IS INCORRECT

Apply the idea and choose the INCORRECT statement.

11. Which statement about the impact of metallurgy is INCORRECT?

- A. It increased trade and commerce.
- B. It led to better tools and ornaments.
- C. It decreased agricultural productivity.
- D. Metals were exchanged between regions.

Reference from: NAS 2024 Grade 9 model paper, Q3 (p.3); NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.4.

12. Which statement about hunter-gatherers is INCORRECT?

- A. They moved in search of food.
- B. They built large permanent cities.
- C. They used stone tools.
- D. They hunted animals and gathered fruits.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.2.

13. Which statement about the New Stone Age (Neolithic) is INCORRECT?

- A. People grew crops and reared animals.
- B. People used polished stone tools.
- C. People built factories and railways.
- D. People lived in settled villages.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.3.

14. Which statement about Harappan technology is INCORRECT?

- A. They made objects of bronze.
- B. They made seals and beads.
- C. They used electricity for street lights.
- D. They planned cities with drains.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.4.

15. Which statement about the effects of early farming is INCORRECT?

- A. It changed people's food habits.
- B. It encouraged settled life.
- C. It allowed the storing of surplus grain.
- D. It ended all hunting and gathering everywhere at once.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.3.

16. Which statement about sources for the Indus Valley civilisation is INCORRECT?

- A. Archaeological remains are the most useful source.
- B. Colonial administrative records are the most useful primary source.
- C. Seals are a source of information.
- D. The Harappan script is not yet deciphered.

Reference from: NAS 2024 Grade 9 model paper, Q19 (p.10); NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.4.

17. Which statement about Magadha's geography is INCORRECT?

- A. The Ganga plains aided agriculture.
- B. Abundant resources aided trade.
- C. An arid climate with no rivers made it nomadic.
- D. It became an important political centre.

Reference from: NAS 2024 Grade 9 model paper, Q18 (p.10).

18. Which statement about the sequence of ages is INCORRECT?

- A. Old, Middle and New Stone Ages are all Stone Ages.
- B. The Iron Age came before the Old Stone Age.
- C. Metals came into use after stone tools.
- D. Copper was among the first metals used.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.2-4.

19. Which statement about Ashoka and the Kalinga war is INCORRECT?

- A. The war caused great death and suffering.
- B. Ashoka gave up war afterwards.
- C. Ashoka spread the message of dhamma.
- D. Ashoka became eager to fight many more wars.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.8.

20. Which statement about early food habits is INCORRECT?

- A. People hunted animals.
- B. People gathered fruits and roots.
- C. People caught fish.
- D. People bought food from supermarkets.

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.2.

SECTION 3 - PARAGRAPH / CONTEXT / DATA-BASED

Read the passage or data and answer the question that follows.

21. At Mehrgarh, the oldest layers have bones of wild animals, but the later layers have more and more bones of sheep and goats.

This change best shows that the people had begun to:

- A. Give up eating meat
- B. Domesticate (rear) animals
- C. Stop farming
- D. Leave the village

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.3 (Mehrgarh).

- 22.** In a Harappan city, the streets were laid out in a grid and every house was connected to a covered drain.

This passage shows that the Harappans had:

- A.** No knowledge of building
- B.** Careful town planning
- C.** Only tents to live in
- D.** No system for waste water

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.4.

- 23.** Tools of a region - Old Stone Age: rough stone; New Stone Age: polished stone; a later period: copper; a still later period: iron.

The overall trend is that tools were made from:

- A.** Weaker materials over time
- B.** Better and harder materials over time
- C.** Only wood
- D.** Smaller and useless materials

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.2-4.

- 24.** After a terrible war with a huge loss of life, an emperor felt deep sorrow, gave up war for ever and began to teach non-violence.

The emperor and the idea he adopted are:

- A.** Ashoka - Ahimsa (non-violence)
- B.** Buddha - warfare
- C.** Mahavira - conquest
- D.** A Harappan king - trade

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.8.

- 25.** A region of fertile Ganga plains with plenty of water and resources became a powerful kingdom with large cities and busy trade.

This best explains the rise of:

- A.** A nomadic desert culture
- B.** A strong farming-and-trade kingdom like Magadha
- C.** A city with no farming
- D.** Isolated forest settlements

Reference from: NAS 2024 Grade 9 model paper, Q18 (p.10).

- 26.** Early people noticed that seeds sprout where they fall; they began sowing seeds, stayed near the fields to tend the crops, and built villages.

This passage describes the beginning of:

- A.** Industry
- B.** Agriculture and settled life
- C.** Sea trade

D. Iron-making

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.3.

- 27.** A settlement shows copper tools, ornaments, and evidence of trade with distant regions.

The metal tools/ornaments and long-distance exchange best show the impact of:

- A.** Metallurgy increasing trade and craft
- B.** The decline of farming
- C.** The end of trade
- D.** A loss of skills

Reference from: NAS 2024 Grade 9 model paper, Q3 (p.3); NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.4.

- 28.** Archaeologists find seals, bricks and tools of the Harappans, but cannot read their writing.

For studying this civilisation, the most useful source is:

- A.** Colonial records
- B.** Archaeological remains
- C.** Modern textbooks
- D.** Temple inscriptions

Reference from: NAS 2024 Grade 9 model paper, Q19 (p.10); NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.4.

- 29.** A group hunts deer, catches fish, gathers fruits, and moves on when the food runs out.

These people are best described as:

- A.** Farmers
- B.** Nomadic hunter-gatherers
- C.** City-dwellers
- D.** Traders

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.2.

- 30.** Pots were used to store grain and to cook food, and the potter's wheel helped make them.

The technology described here is:

- A.** Metallurgy
- B.** Pottery
- C.** Weaving
- D.** Writing

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.3-4.

SECTION 4 - ASSERTION - REASONING

Each item has an Assertion (A) and a Reason (R). Choose the correct option.

- 31. Assertion (A):** Metallurgy increased trade and commerce in early societies.

Reason (R): Metal tools and ornaments were valued and were exchanged between regions.

- A.** Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
- B.** Both A and R are true, but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
- C.** A is true but R is false
- D.** A is false but R is true

Reference from: NAS 2024 Grade 9 model paper, Q3 (p.3); NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-1', Ch.4.

- 32. Assertion (A):** The beginning of agriculture led to settled village life.

Reason (R): Once people grew crops, they had to stay near the fields to tend them.

- A.** Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
- B.** Both A and R are true, but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
- C.** A is true but R is false
- D.** A is false but R is true

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-1', Ch.3.

- 33. Assertion (A):** Magadha became an important political and cultural centre.

Reason (R): The Ganga's fertile plains and abundant resources supported agriculture and trade.

- A.** Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
- B.** Both A and R are true, but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
- C.** A is true but R is false
- D.** A is false but R is true

Reference from: NAS 2024 Grade 9 model paper, Q18 (p.10).

- 34. Assertion (A):** Archaeological remains are the most useful source for the Indus Valley.

Reason (R): The Harappan script has been fully deciphered.

- A.** Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
- B.** Both A and R are true, but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
- C.** A is true but R is false
- D.** A is false but R is true

Reference from: NAS 2024 Grade 9 model paper, Q19 (p.10); NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-1', Ch.4.

- 35. Assertion (A):** Ashoka gave up war after the battle of Kalinga.

Reason (R): Ashoka wanted to conquer many more lands through war.

- A.** Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
- B.** Both A and R are true, but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
- C.** A is true but R is false
- D.** A is false but R is true

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-1', Ch.8.

- 36. Assertion (A):** Pottery was an important technology for early farmers.

Reason (R): Pots were used to store surplus grain and to cook food.

- A.** Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
- B.** Both A and R are true, but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
- C.** A is true but R is false
- D.** A is false but R is true

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-1', Ch.3-4.

37. Assertion (A): The New Stone Age is also called the Neolithic.

Reason (R): New Stone Age people used polished stone tools and had begun farming.

- A.** Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
- B.** Both A and R are true, but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
- C.** A is true but R is false
- D.** A is false but R is true

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.3.

38. Assertion (A): Early humans made tools from stone.

Reason (R): India is a peninsula surrounded by water on three sides.

- A.** Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
- B.** Both A and R are true, but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
- C.** A is true but R is false
- D.** A is false but R is true

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.2.

39. Assertion (A): Harappan cities had covered drains and planned streets.

Reason (R): The Harappans had good town-planning skills.

- A.** Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
- B.** Both A and R are true, but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
- C.** A is true but R is false
- D.** A is false but R is true

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.4.

40. Assertion (A): The domestication of animals changed early people's way of life.

Reason (R): People began rearing sheep, goats and cattle instead of only hunting them.

- A.** Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
- B.** Both A and R are true, but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
- C.** A is true but R is false
- D.** A is false but R is true

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.3.

ANSWER KEY WITH EXPLANATIONS

SECTION 1 - WHICH OF THE FOLLOWING IS CORRECT

1. (B) Metal tools and ornaments were valued and exchanged, so metallurgy increased trade and commerce.
2. (C) Fertile river plains and resources supported farming, trade and important political/cultural centres.
3. (C) Since the Harappan script is undeciphered, archaeological remains (seals, bricks, tools) are the most useful source.
4. (B) People who move about hunting and gathering are nomadic hunter-gatherers.
5. (B) Growing crops meant staying near fields, so agriculture led to settled life.
6. (B) Harappan cities were carefully planned, with brick houses and covered drains.
7. (B) Ahimsa means non-violence, an idea central to Jainism and Buddhism.
8. (B) The suffering of Kalinga led Ashoka to give up war and spread dhamma and non-violence.
9. (B) Tools progressed from stone to copper/bronze to iron.
10. (B) Megaliths are big-stone burials; the way the dead were buried tells us about beliefs about death.

SECTION 2 - WHICH OF THE FOLLOWING IS INCORRECT

11. (C) Metallurgy did NOT decrease productivity; it improved tools/ornaments and boosted trade.
12. (B) Hunter-gatherers were nomadic; they did NOT build large permanent cities.
13. (C) Factories and railways are modern; they did not exist in the Neolithic.
14. (C) The Harappans had no electricity - that is a modern technology.
15. (D) Hunting and gathering continued alongside farming for a long time; it did not end at once.
16. (B) Archaeological remains - not colonial records - are the most useful source for the Harappans.
17. (C) Magadha had the fertile Ganga plains, not an arid, riverless climate.
18. (B) The Iron Age came much LATER, not before the Old Stone Age.
19. (D) After Kalinga, Ashoka GAVE UP war; he did not seek more wars.
20. (D) Supermarkets are modern; early people hunted, gathered and fished.

SECTION 3 - PARAGRAPH / CONTEXT / DATA-BASED

21. (B) More bones of sheep and goats over time show the rearing (domestication) of animals.
22. (B) Grid streets and covered drains show careful town planning.
23. (B) Stone -> copper -> iron shows a move to progressively harder, better materials.
24. (A) This describes Ashoka, who adopted Ahimsa after the Kalinga war.
25. (B) Fertile plains and resources support the rise of a strong agricultural-and-trade kingdom such as Magadha.
26. (B) Observing and sowing seeds and staying to tend crops is the beginning of agriculture and settled life.
27. (A) Metal goods and long-distance exchange show how metallurgy boosted craft and trade.
28. (B) As the script is unreadable, archaeological remains are the most useful source.
29. (B) Hunting, fishing, gathering and moving on describes nomadic hunter-gatherers.
30. (B) Storing grain and cooking, using the potter's wheel, describes pottery.

SECTION 4 - ASSERTION - REASONING

31. (A) Both true, and the exchange of valued metal goods is why trade grew.
32. (A) Both true, and staying near the fields is exactly why farming led to settling.
33. (A) Both true, and the fertile plains/resources are the reason Magadha rose.

- 34. (C)** A is true, but R is false - the Harappan script is NOT yet deciphered.
- 35. (C)** A is true, but R is false - Ashoka gave up conquest, he did not want more war.
- 36. (A)** Both true, and storing grain/cooking is exactly why pottery mattered.
- 37. (B)** Both statements are true, but R (their tools/farming) does not explain the NAME 'Neolithic'.
- 38. (B)** Both statements are true, but R (India's shape) does not explain A (stone tools).
- 39. (A)** Both true, and their planning skill is exactly why the cities had drains and grid streets.
- 40. (A)** Both true, and rearing animals (instead of only hunting) is what changed their life.